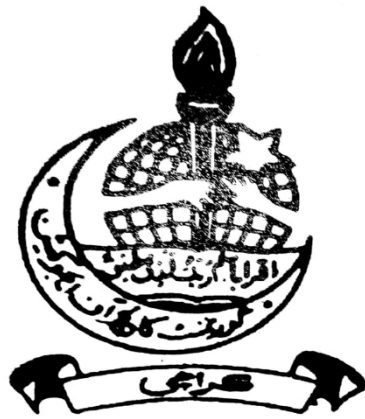


**Breaking Traditional Norms-Implementing Cooperative Learning
Strategies To Make Learning Effective in Social Studies Classroom**

by

YUMNA MAHMOOD

Seat # A1-22160052



An action research report submitted in partial fulfillment of
the requirements for the degree of
B.Ed.

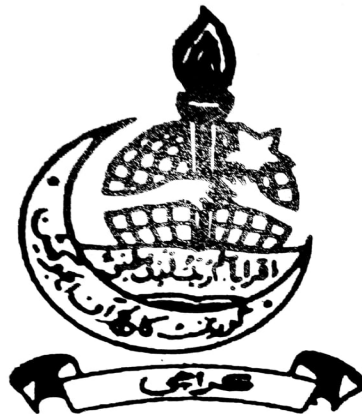
**GOVERNMENT COLLEGE OF EDUCATION
F.B. AREA, KARACHI**

(May 2025)

Breaking Traditional Norms-Implementing Cooperative Learning Strategies To Make Learning Effective in Social Studies Classroom

by

YUMNA MAHMOOD



Supervised

By

Prof. TABASSUM KAUSER

An action research report submitted in partial fulfillment of
the requirements for the degree of
B.Ed.

GOVERNMENT COLLEGE OF EDUCATION

F.B. AREA, KARACH

(May, 2025)



“Read, and your Lord is the most Generous—Who taught by the pen—Taught man that which he knew not.”

(Surah Al-‘Alaq 96:3-5)

“The superiority of the scholar over the worshipper is like that of the moon over all other heavenly bodies.”

(Sunan Abu Dawood, Hadith 3641)

“Whoever treads a path in search of knowledge, Allah will make easy for him a path to Paradise.”

(Sahih Muslim, Hadith 2699)

ABSTRACT

This research discovers the role and impact of cooperative learning strategies on students' learning in Social Studies classroom, Grade VIII. Recognizing cooperative learning as an effective tool to enhance students' learning of Social Studies, this research aims to incorporate it in Social Studies lesson plans of Grade VIII. This is action research based on a qualitative design, using students' feedback as the main source of data, along with researcher's field notes and observations. This study concludes that cooperative learning strategies increase students' engagement in Social Studies classrooms and improves their learning as compared to traditional lecture-based methods.

DEDICATION*

The work is dedicated to Professor Madam Afshan Jabbar (Late) who always reminded me of my strengths and motivated me for higher studies. She is no longer with me, but the confidence she has built in me is something that has made me capable of achieving all the success today.

Govt. College of Education, F.B. Area, Karachi

DECLARATION

I, **Yumna Mahmood**, daughter of **Mahmood Akhter**, a student of B.Ed. (Hons) Secondary, hereby declare that this action research project report, titled “**Breaking Traditional Norms-Implementing Cooperative Learning Strategies To Make Learning Effective In Social Studies Classroom,**” is the result of my own independent effort. I affirm that no part of this work has been plagiarized, and all sources have been properly cited wherever required.

I fully understand that the University of Karachi reserves the right to revoke my degree if any part of this declaration is found to be false, either before or after the awarding of the degree.

Signature of the Candidate: _____

Name of Candidate: Yumna Mahmood

Seat Number: A1-22160052

Govt. College of Education, F.B. Area, Karachi

CERTIFICATE OF APPROVAL

Yumna Mahmood D/o,**Mahmood Akhter** student of B.Ed. (Hons) Secondary has completed the Action Research Project entitled “**Breaking Traditional Norms - Implementing Cooperative Learning Strategies To Make Learning Effective In Social Studies Classroom**” as the scholarly standard set in HEC research project course guide/University of Karachi.

Signature of the Candidate: _____

Name of Candidate: **Yumna Mahmood**

Signature of the Supervisor: _____

Name of the supervisor: **Prof. Tabassum Kauser**

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I am extremely grateful to Allah S.W.T. for giving me strength and courage to complete this report. Many thanks to my Supervisor, [Professor Tabassum Kauser] for editing and proofreading my work and suggesting corrections. She has been patient with me which made this journey really easy for me. Lastly, I am indebted to my parents, especially my father, without whose support I wouldn't have compiled this report.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

ABSTRACT.....	IV
DEDICATION*	V
DECLARATION.....	VI
CERTIFICATE OF APPROVAL.....	VII
ACKNOWLEDGEMENT.....	VIII
CHAPTER ONE INTRODUCTION.....	1
1.1 Background of the Problem/Context of the Study.....	1
1.2 Statement of the Problem.....	1
1.3 Objectives.....	2
1.4 Research Questions.....	2
1.5 Significance of the Study.....	3
1.6 Delimitation of the Study.....	3
1.7 Operational Definition of Key Terms.....	4
CHAPTER TWO LITERATURE REVIEW.....	5
2.1 Defining Social Studies.....	5
2.2 Cooperative Learning.....	6
2.3 Cooperative Learning Approach Design.....	7

2.4 Integration of Cooperative Learning Strategies in Social studies and Their Outcomes.....	9
2.5 Challenges of Implementing Cooperative Learning Strategies in Classroom.....	12
CHAPTER THREE RESEARCH METHODOLOGY.....	14
3.1 Research Design.....	14
3.1.1 Qualitative Research Design:.....	14
3.1.2 Action Research Design:.....	14
3.1.3 Model of Action Research:.....	15
3.2 Research Site.....	16
3.3 Participants.....	16
3.4 Research Instruments & Data Sources.....	16
3.5 Procedure of Data Collection.....	17
3.6 Data Analysis.....	17
3.6.1 Pre-intervention Data.....	17
3.6.2 Post-intervention Data.....	17
3.7 Ethical Considerations.....	19
CHAPTER FOUR DATA ANALYSIS AND REFLECTIONS.....	20
4.1. Assigning Initial Codes:.....	20
4.2 Grouping Codes Into Themes.....	22

4.3 Reviewing Themes:.....	25
4.4 Defining and Naming Themes:.....	25
4.5 Producing the Report or Manuscript:.....	28
CHAPTER FIVE CONCLUSIONS & IMPLICATIONS.....	30
5.1 Findings and Conclusion:.....	30
5.2 Implications:.....	31
5.3 Limitations:.....	31
REFERENCES.....	32

LIST OF TABLES

Table 1 Codes assigned to Key Phrases of Students' Reflections.....	20
Table 2 Codes assigned to the key phrases of researcher's reflections.....	21
Table 3 Themes assigned to codes of students' reflections and rationale behind them	22
Table 4 Themes assigned to Codes to researcher's reflections and Rationale behind them.....	24

LIST OF FIGURES

Figure 1 Lewin's Action Research Cycle.....	15
---	----

CHAPTER ONE

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background of the Problem/Context of the Study

Social Studies is a compulsory subject at secondary levels (Agarwal, 2019), yet it has been regarded as a subject not liked much by students (Schug et al., 1982). This action research is conducted in a secondary school in Dastagir, Karachi, focusing on making the Social Studies classroom interesting and engaging for Grade 8 students by incorporating cooperative learning strategies into lesson plans. The setting of this research is a Grade 8 classroom where the traditional lecture method, combined with a question-answer technique, is predominantly used for lesson delivery. Initial observations revealed that the cooperative teacher relied solely on the lecture method, with the blackboard as the only teaching aid, and audio-visual or ICT resources were not utilized. Many practitioners have noted that the lecture method is the most commonly used approach in Social Studies teaching (Akpan & Nkan, 2022), but its effectiveness is limited (Aliyu, 2017) compared to newer methods like inquiry-based approaches (Aliyu, 2017) and cooperative learning strategies (Ajaja & Mezieobi, 2018). This research builds on the understanding that traditional methods may not adequately engage students, prompting the need to explore alternative strategies.

1.2 Statement of the Problem

Despite being a compulsory subject, Social Studies is often perceived as uninteresting by secondary students (Schug et al., 1982), and the predominant use of the lecture method in classrooms exacerbates this issue (Hultquist, 2024). Observations in a Grade 8 classroom in Karachi indicated that students lost interest in lessons delivered via

the lecture method within a 40-minute class period, struggling to maintain focus, attention, and engagement with the content. The lack of modern teaching aids and reliance on traditional methods, such as the blackboard, further diminished student participation. This recurring challenge of keeping students active and interested highlights a gap in effective teaching strategies for Social Studies. The problem is significant because it directly affects students' learning outcomes and academic performance in formative and summative assessments, necessitating a shift to more engaging methods like cooperative learning to improve classroom dynamics and student interest.

1.3 Objectives

The primary objectives of this action research are:

1. To explore how cooperative learning strategies can make learning effective and engaging in the Social Studies classroom for Grade 8 students.
2. To design and implement lesson plans that integrate cooperative learning strategies to enhance student participation and interest.
3. To evaluate the impact of cooperative learning on students' classroom performance and learning outcomes compared to the traditional lecture method.
4. To provide practitioners and teachers with insights and methodologies for making Social Studies teaching more productive and student-centered.

1.4 Research Questions

research questions guiding this action research are:

1. How can Social Studies classrooms be made effective?

2. What role do cooperative learning strategies play in making the Social Studies classroom interesting?

1.5 Significance of the Study

This research is significant because it addresses the critical need to enhance teaching in Social Studies classrooms, where student disinterest and limited engagement directly impact academic performance (Kelley, 2021). By investigating cooperative learning strategies, the study offers practical solutions for teachers and practitioners seeking to make Social Studies more appealing and effective at the secondary level. The findings contribute to the existing body of knowledge by providing actionable insights into designing lesson plans and evaluation methodologies that incorporate cooperative learning. This approach empowers students to take charge of their learning, maximizes classroom productivity, and ensures active participation throughout lessons. Ultimately, the research aims to improve students' learning outcomes in formative and summative assessments, addressing the limitations of the traditional lecture method (Aliyu, 2017) and supporting the shift toward modern, student-centered teaching practices.

1.6 Delimitation of the Study

This action research is delimited to a specific context: a Grade 8 classroom in a secondary school in Dastagir, Karachi, with a focus on the subject of Social Studies. The study involves eight female Grade 8 students who participated with informed consent and does not extend to other grade levels, subjects, or schools. The research specifically examines the implementation of cooperative learning strategies as an alternative to the traditional lecture method within a 40-minute class period. Data collection is limited to field observations, unstructured interviews with the cooperative teacher and participants,

and student feedback, with observations and reflections serving as the primary data sources. The study does not explore other teaching methods, such as inquiry-based learning, in depth, nor does it incorporate advanced technological resources beyond what is available in the classroom setting.

1.7 Operational Definition of Key Terms

- a. Social Studies:** A compulsory subject at the secondary level that encompasses topics related to history, geography, civics, and culture, as taught in the Grade 8 classroom in this study (Agarwal, 2019).
- b. Cooperative Learning Strategies:** Teaching methods that involve students working collaboratively in small groups to achieve shared learning goals, implemented in this research to enhance engagement and effectiveness in the Social Studies classroom (Ajaja & Mezieobi, 2018).
- c. Lecture Method:** A traditional teaching approach where the teacher delivers content verbally to students, often supplemented by a question-answer technique, as observed in the Grade 8 classroom prior to the intervention (Akpan & Nkan, 2022).
- d. Effective Classroom:** A learning environment where students are actively engaged, maintain focus, and demonstrate improved learning outcomes, as measured by participation and performance in this study.
- e. Engagement:** The degree of student interest, attention, and active participation in Social Studies lessons, assessed through observations and feedback in this research.

CHAPTER TWO

LITERATURE REVIEW

Education is the key to prosperity. Its aim is to produce educated citizens and informed individuals who can stand for their nation, make sound decisions, and serve one's country the best. Throughout their academic career, students are taught many subjects to enhance their knowledge about the world they live in and one such course is Social Studies which is part of the National Curriculum as well.

2.1 Defining Social Studies

Social Studies is taught as a core subject in secondary grades in Pakistan (Ali, Karim, 2021). Social Studies is a field that is still in process of forming an identity (Nelson, 2001).

It is difficult to define Social Studies because of its confusing past, contradictory conceptual notions, and stark ideological differences in political and educational philosophy (Nelson, 2001) He defines Social Studies as, “the social sciences simplified for pedagogical purposes.” By the virtue of this definition, Social Studies is a subject that has evolved from Social Sciences for the purpose of teaching concepts of social sciences, such as environmental changes, history, sociology, etc in educational settings.

Among the school subjects, Social Studies is a subject that encompasses a wide range of topics. The aim of this subject is to produce knowledgeable citizens with the ability to think critically and rationally for the betterment of culturally diverse interdependent societies by maintaining democratic manners (Shah et al, 2024).

2.2 Cooperative Learning

Cooperative learning is sometimes taken synonymous with collaborative learning which is incorrect. Xigui Yang (2023) writes about the two approaches that they have been established independently around the same time in 1960's and 1970's. They share many commonalities but yet have distinct characteristics because of the varied beginnings and entwined developmental pathways.

Igel and Urquhart (2016) has explained that collaborative learning occurs when students work together in groups, while cooperative learning, a subset of collaborative learning, is highly structured with certain elements that address teachers' concerns about uneven efforts among participants.

Cooperative learning has been defined by many scholars. A few definitions are below:

The term cooperative learning (CL) refers to students working in teams on an assignment or project under conditions in which certain criteria are satisfied, including that the team members be held individually accountable for the complete content of the assignment or project (Felder, Brent, 2007).

It is a group-initiated mode that attempts to establish individual accountability within the group (Sullivan, 2010).

Cooperative learning process is a set of alternatives to traditional instruction systems, or more specifically, techniques in which students work in heterogeneous groups of four to six members and earn recognition, rewards, and sometimes grades based on the academic performance of their group (Slavin, 1983).

Hosseini et al (2017) states that cooperative Learning occurs when students are organized in small groups in order to realize academic achievements, and specific purpose determines the activity for each of them. When the results are achieved, all members of the group are able to share, comment, and debate the various aspects of its educational content. He further quotes Slavin (2004) that if only one member of the group is actively working and the rest are spectators, in this case, cooperative learning has not occurred.

According to Anse and Ilham, (2018) Cooperative learning is one type of peer mediated-instruction that involves small and heterogeneous groups of students working together in a non-competitive manner to maximize their own and other's learning.

Cooperative learning is an evidence-based teaching strategy. In cooperative learning, teachers structure students' interactions and prepare them for cooperation so that students work together in small groups supporting each other's learning processes (Abramczyk, Jurkowski, 2019).

The Cooperative Learning method is a learning method that provides opportunities for students to think critically, answer questions, share opinions, and increase student learning activities, and increase teacher activities in teaching (Kasmiati et al, 2023).

2.3 Cooperative Learning Approach Design

The most approved and well-established explanation of the Cooperative Learning design has been provided by Johnson (1991). According to Johnson, for a lesson to be Cooperative in design, it should have 5 key elements, namely; positive interdependence,

face-to-face promotive interactions, individual accountability, interpersonal and small group skills, and group processing.

1. Positive Interdependence

Johnson defines this element as the perception that you are linked with others in a way so that you cannot succeed unless they do (and vice versa) and their work benefits you and your work benefits them. It promotes a situation in which individuals work together in small groups to maximize the learning of all members.

2. Face-to-Face Promotive Interaction

Cooperative learning requires face-to-face interaction among children within which they promote each other's learning and success. There is no magic in positive interdependence in and of itself. It is the interaction patterns and verbal interchange among children promoted by the positive interdependence that affect education outcomes.

3. Individual Accountability

This element indicates that every individual in a cooperative group, and part of the cooperative learning is accountable or responsible for his progress as well. This ensures that individuals contribute to and understand the group's work and that each child can individually apply some knowledge learned in a group (Lynda Baloché, 1994).

4. Interpersonal and Small Group Skills

This refers to the necessary social skills required to work in small groups, such as communication, empathy, mutual understanding, and encouraging each other to

learn. Again, these skills are developed over time and don't develop magically.

More complex skills include repeating an idea, making a plan, criticising ideas, and asking for justifications (Lynda Baloché, 1994).

5. Group Processing

It includes evaluating how well they are completing tasks to fulfill their academic goal and how well they are working on improving their working relationship.

2.4 Integration of Cooperative Learning Strategies in Social studies and Their Outcomes

A couple of researchers have integrated cooperative learning strategies such as Make a Match, Time Token, Jigsaw, Scripted Cooperative learning, and Numbered Head Together in Social Studies Lessons and have found positive results.

Results of research by Babatunde A. Adeyemi (2008) revealed that cooperative learning strategy is the best followed by problem solving strategy and conventional strategy and that cooperative learning strategy seems more useful than other instructional strategies.

Gul and Shehzad (2015) experimented with grade 12 students enrolled in the subject of Education, by teaching them using multiple cooperative learning activities, such as Jigsaw II, Student Team Achievement Division (STAD), and Teams Game Tournament (TGT) and found out that cooperative learning activities had a positive effect on academic achievement of those students.

While comparing different learning styles and the effect of cooperative learning on the learning approaches of children, Colak (2015) discovered that students with cooperative learning styles fared better than students with participative learning

styles. This shows the effectiveness of cooperative learning style in comparison to avoidant and participative learning. This study also supported the view that as cooperative learning supports deeper learning, it is better than other learning methods.

The experimental study by Toklucu and Tay (2016) with a group of 110 students found that cooperative learning and the systematic teaching and constructivist learning approaches were effective in enhancing student achievement and retention in social studies lessons.

A formal research conducted by Hosseini et al (2017) on students studying in high school physical education in a school of Kurdistan Province in the year 2014-2015, aiming to investigate the effects of cooperative learning on student academic achievement concluded that cooperative learning has a significant impact on student achievement. The main aspects of this type of learning highlighted by Hosseini et al are constructive gathering, interaction within class, and the collaborating at unison for significant academic results. However, this research uses collaborative learning as a synonym of cooperative learning which is incorrect.

Anse and Ilham (2018) while working to explore the results of implementing cooperative learning strategy Numbered Head Together (NHT) on grade 4 children found out that the implementation of Cooperative learning (NHT) is able to boost students' learning outcome in social studies. Being an action research, this also has narrow generalizability and doesn't fit true for grade 8 students which this study aims to find out.

An action research report by Khakim et al (2019) based on incorporating Make a Match Cooperative learning activity in social studies lessons of grade 5 yielded that

the implementation of cooperative learning, can improve the social science learning activities and learning outcomes. However, this research, being action research, has limited generalizability.

Research from Poland by Abramczyk and Jurkowski (2019) concluded that teachers agreed that cooperative learning is effective for students' academic and social learning and can provide students with individualized support for their learning processes. This research also addressed the issue that despite its effectiveness, teachers didn't use cooperative learning very often.

Another research on discovering the effect of Jigsaw Cooperative Method on learning outcomes was done by Salamah et al (2019) at a secondary school by combining it with silent reading methods and the results yielded that Jigsaw method combined with silent reading can improve learning outcomes in Social Sciences.

Ismail (2020) implemented Jigsaw Cooperative Learning Model to improve learning outcomes of Social Science learning in 11th grade social studies. This was an action research study, and the results yielded confirmed that application of Jigsaw Cooperative model improves the activities and learning outcomes of students.

Another Action Research based on implementing Method of Cooperative Learning Type Time Token (TITO) by Herianto et al (2021) conducted with grade 7 students. The researchers mention that through TITO cooperative learning model, students are able to more actively express their opinions in learning and be able to listen to others. The research concludes that cooperative learning method, combined with lecture and question-and-answer techniques, helped improve students'

participation and learning outcomes in integrated social sciences (IPS) at MTs Nurul Masakin Karang Lebah.

Through their research on students majoring in Social Sciences at Wawotobi High School, Kasmianti et al (2023) working on how to improve student learning outcomes by the application of Scripted Cooperative Learning found that cooperative learning through a Script model significantly increases overall value of student learning outcome. This research followed experimental research design on a population size of 30 students in grade 3, therefore the findings can be true for the Script Model of Cooperative Learning but the same for other models of cooperative learning cannot be generalized.

Formal research conducted by Shah et al (2024) in Mansehra, Pakistan, with 7th grade students, examining the effect of cooperative learning on students' social self-efficacy and self-esteem in Social Studies classroom discovered that Cooperative Learning is an effective intervention for maximizing students' social self-efficacy and self-esteem across diverse achievement levels. Hence, the results are in favor of the claim that cooperative learning strategies improve student achievement in the Social Studies classroom.

2.5 Challenges of Implementing Cooperative Learning Strategies in Classroom

Despite its success, there are certain challenges that are faced by teachers or educators, and sometimes students while practicing cooperative learning strategies.

1. The foremost challenge is the teacher's ability to enrich the curriculum through effective research and dialogue procedures (Sullivan, 2010)

2. Teachers frequently find that groups larger than four are cumbersome, noisy, and time consuming and that some members feel left out of discussions and decisions (Baloche, 1994).

3. Implementing cooperative learning is challenging for teachers because of the time and effort needed to prepare lessons (Abramczyk, Jurkowski, 2019).

4. Groups sometimes face difficulty in properly structuring and organizing their discussion activities during teamwork-based activities (Colak, 2015).

5. Students with dependent and avoidant learning styles experience difficulties in adapting to cooperative learning environments (Colak, 2015).

CHAPTER THREE RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 Research Design

The research was conducted on the topic of ‘Breaking Traditional Norms-Implementing Co-operative Learning Strategies To Make Learning Effective In S.St. Classrooms.’ The study aimed to investigate whether incorporating cooperative teaching strategies improved students' classroom performance. Cooperative teaching methods, such as agree-disagree line-ups, jigsaw learning, and think-pair-share, were implemented in lesson plans to shift from traditional, teacher-centered delivery to an approach fostering active student participation.

3.1.1 Qualitative Research Design:

The study was completely qualitative in nature, i.e. based on qualitative data types such as reflections from participants, observations and reflections of the researcher, and unstructured interview of the cooperative teacher.

3.1.2 Action Research Design:

The study is action research which is a reflective process of progressive problem-solving to solve immediate problems. It is a cyclical process involving planning, acting, observing, and reflecting. The research cycles have been conducted in the Social Studies Classroom.

3.1.3 Model of Action Research:

The Action Research Model chosen for the study is Lewin's Action Research Model (The Classic Model) which involves the following steps:

Planning: Identifying a problem and developing a plan of action.

Acting: Implementing the plan.

Observing: Collecting data on the effects of the action.

Reflecting: Analyzing the data and evaluating the effectiveness of the action.

Figure 1 Lewin's Action Research Cycle

The cycle repeats, with each cycle building on the previous one. In each cycle,

1. Lesson plans were designed in the planning part
2. Cooperative learning strategies were introduced in the acting part
3. Observations were taken by the practitioner in the observation part, and
4. Reflections were collected from the participants and also written by the practitioner in
5. the reflection part of the lesson plan and a reflection diary.

3.2 Research Site

The research took place in a Government School in Metropolitan city, Karachi, in Dastagir. The action research cycles were conducted specifically during the Social Studies period in Grade VIII classrooms. The slot for the Social Studies period was 40 minutes and was divided into pre-intervention observation, intervention, and post intervention reflections.

3.3 Participants

The participants were Grade VIII students at the Government School in Karachi, who were mostly girls. Their amount varied from 5-8 depending upon their presence and absence during regular classes. The study also involved a prospective teacher responsible for delivering the Social Studies lessons during the research cycles who was observed during the observation section of the action research cycle.

3.4 Research Instruments & Data Sources

Pre-intervention data was collected through observation of the prospective teacher's lesson delivery. Preliminary observations focused on student engagement and participation during the 40-minute Social Studies period, including the lecture and recapitulation phases. Indicators such as levels of student interest and participation were noted as key data points.

Post-intervention data includes reflections by the practitioner and reflections taken in written form from the participants.

3.5 Procedure of Data Collection

Data collection began with observing the teacher's lesson delivery for one day prior to the intervention. During the 40-minute Social Studies period, the Cooperative teacher delivered a lecture and recapitulated the lesson at the end, while the researcher made preliminary observations. The observations revealed students' loss of interest within the first 15 minutes and their low participation during recapitulation that was evident from yawning, peer conversation, and low participation in recapitulation.

Following this, cooperative teaching methods were introduced into customized lesson plans for the Social Studies classroom, incorporating cooperative learning strategies in them.

The reflection diary included pre-intervention and Post-intervention reflections by the practitioner that have been used as pre-intervention and Post-intervention data source, respectively. Moreover, the Post-intervention reflections gathered from students have also been used as a data source.

3.6 Data Analysis

The data analysis was conducted of the pre-intervention and Post-intervention data as follows:

3.6.1 Pre-intervention Data

The pre-intervention observations were primarily observations taken during the period of 2-3 days while the cooperative teacher delivered lessons in the classroom.

3.6.2 Post-intervention Data

The post-intervention data consisted of reflections written by the researcher and the participants following the implementation of cooperative teaching strategies in the Social Studies classroom. These reflections, specifically, from the students, captured personal insights, experiences, and perceptions about the effectiveness of the new teaching methods.

Braun and Clarke's (2006) thematic analysis method is a structured, six-phase approach to analyzing qualitative data, widely used in research to identify, organize, and interpret patterns (themes) within data.

To analyze this qualitative data, the following steps were employed using Braun and Clark thematic analysis method.

1. Familiarization with the Data

This step involves immersing in the data by reading and re-reading it to become deeply familiar with its content, noting initial impressions like recurring mentions of engagement etc to prepare for coding.

2. Generating Initial Codes

Here, systematic coding of the data by identifying and labeling meaningful segments with descriptive tags is performed. For this research, the coded reflections with labels will break down the data into manageable units.

3. Searching for Themes

In this phase, related codes are grouped into potential themes that reflect broader patterns.

4. Reviewing Themes

This step involves refining themes to ensure they accurately represent the data and align with the research aim.

5. Defining and Naming Themes

Here, a clear definition of what each theme represents is stated and is given a concise name.

6. Producing the Report

The final step is writing a narrative that presents the themes, supported by data extracts, to address the research question.

3.7 Ethical Considerations

Ethical considerations were carefully followed throughout the research process. The following measures were taken:

- 1. Informed Consent:** Participants were informed about the purpose of data collection and their consent was taken.
- 2. Confidentiality:** The identity of the participants have been kept confidential throughout the report. Pseudonyms have been used in the report for the sake of confidentiality.
- 3. Respect for Participants:** The researcher ensured to respect all participants and value their input.

By following the above mentioned ethical guidelines, the researcher ensured the transparency of the study and confidentiality of the data of the participants.

CHAPTER FOUR

DATA ANALYSIS AND REFLECTIONS

Data for this action research has been analysed using thematic analysis as described by Braun and Clark (2006). The detailed analysis of themes has been conducted.

4.1. Assigning Initial Codes:

Initial codes were assigned to the key phrases of the data of feedback from the students and reflections composed by the researcher.

Table 1 Codes assigned to Key Phrases of Students' Reflections

S.No.	Key Phrases	Codes assigned
1.	I liked (the activity)	Overall positive experience
2.	Very nice activity / Good activity	Positive engagement
3.	Interesting activity	Expressing interest
4.	Enjoyed a lot	Positive engagement
5.	Learned a lot in a very little amount of time	Time effective learning
6.	We are thankful to you	Gratitude towards instructor
7.	Want to study the same way forever	Long-term adaptation to the method
8.	Should be conducted daily	Daily engagement desired
9.	We were made in groups	Reflections on procedure
10.	We get to know things	Understanding of the content

S.No.	Key Phrases	Codes assigned
11.	Keep teaching us this way	Likenesses toward instructor and method of instruction
12.	Think pair share is an amazing activity	Specific method appreciated
13.	Activity is amazing	Positive experience

Table 2 Codes assigned to the key phrases of researcher's reflections

S.No.	Key Phrases	Codes Assigned
1.	Enjoyed the agree-disagree line- up activity	Enjoyment
2.	New experience for students	Novelty
3.	Faces difficulty in expressing agreement or disagreement	Expression difficulty
4.	Obvious from their confidence	Confident obvious
5.	Proficiently learning the content	Proficient learning
6.	Sooner than the last time	Speed up progress

4.2 Grouping Codes Into Themes

In this phase, the codes were assembled into closely related themes along with the rationale to assigning those themes. Following are the two tables that contain the themes into which student feedback codes and researcher's reflection codes are assembled into relevant themes.

Table 3 Themes assigned to codes of students' reflections and rationale behind them

S.No.	Codes	Themes	Rationale for assigning themes
1.	Positive engagement (x2), Expressing interest, Daily engagement desired	Student Engagement	These codes reflect the students' active interest and desire to engage with the activity regularly, addressing the pre-intervention disengagement you observed.
2.	Overall positive experience, Positive experience, Gratitude towards instructor, Likenesses toward instructor and method of	Positive Experience	These codes capture the students' general positive feelings about the activity, instructor, and method, indicating an overall favorable response.

S.No.	Codes	Themes	Rationale for assigning themes
	instruction		
3.	Time effective learning, Understanding of the content	Learning Outcomes	These codes focus on the efficiency and effectiveness of learning, suggesting the method helped students grasp Social Studies content within the 40-minute period.
4.	Specific method appreciated, Long-term adaptation to the method	Appreciation of Method	These codes highlight the students' approval of the cooperative learning method (e.g., jigsaw, think-pair-share) and their willingness to adopt it long-term.
5.	Reflections on procedure	Reflective Insights	This code stands alone as it pertains to students' thoughts on the process itself, offering procedural feedback rather than emotional or learning outcomes.

Table 4 Themes assigned to Codes to researcher's reflections and Rationale behind them

S.No.	Codes	Themes	Rationale
-------	-------	--------	-----------

1.	Enjoyment	Student engagement	Focuses on the students' emotional and participatory response to the learning activity.
2.	Novelty	Activity experience	Describes the nature of the interaction with the learning task itself.
3.	Expression difficulty	Communication challenges	Identifies obstacles students face in conveying their ideas.
4.	Confident obvious	Demonstrated Understanding	Captures observable signs of comprehension or mastery.
5.	Proficient learning	Learning outcomes	Relates to the level and quality of knowledge or skills acquired.
6.	Speed up progress	Efficiency/pacing	Addresses the rate at which learning or progress is occurring.

4.3 Reviewing Themes:

In the fourth phase of Braun and Clarke's (2006) thematic analysis, the initially identified themes were rigorously reviewed to ensure they meaningfully captured patterns in the post-intervention reflections from Grade VIII students and the researcher. Themes were also assessed for alignment with the research aim of improving classroom performance, ensuring they provided actionable insights, before proceeding to define and name them in the next phase.

4.4 Defining and Naming Themes:

In the fifth phase of Braun and Clarke's (2006) thematic analysis, the identified themes were defined and named to encapsulate their significance in evaluating the impact of cooperative learning strategies on Grade VIII students' classroom performance.

a. Student Engagement:

It was defined as the active interest and participation students exhibited during activities, evidenced by codes like "Positive engagement" and "Daily engagement desired," reflecting a shift from the pre-intervention passivity observed within 40 minutes of Social Studies lessons. Student Engagement highlighted how cooperative methods like think-pair-share transformed passive listeners into active participants, as evidenced by reflections like "Learned a lot in a very little amount of time."

b. Positive Experience:

Positive Engagement captured the students' overall emotional satisfaction and appreciation, incorporating codes such as "Overall positive experience" and "Gratitude towards instructor," highlighting the motivational boost from the intervention. Positive Experience underscored the emotional and motivational benefits, with students expressing gratitude towards the instructor and a desire for long-term adoption of the methods.

c. Learning Outcomes:

It was defined as the academic gains achieved through cooperative methods, with codes like "Understanding of the content" and "Time effective learning" indicating improved comprehension of Social Studies topics within the

40-minute period. Learning Outcomes confirmed academic gains, with students noting better understanding of Social Studies content.

d. Appreciation of Method:

It reflected students' approval and desire for sustained use of cooperative strategies, driven by codes like "Specific method appreciated" and "Long-term adaptation to the method," suggesting the intervention's potential for broader adoption.

e. Reflective Insights:

These encompassed students' procedural feedback, defined by the code "Reflections on procedure," offering valuable perspectives for refining future implementations. Reflective Insights provided procedural feedback, suggesting areas for refinement, such as clearer instructions.

Themes assigned to teacher's reflection have been defined below:

a. Student engagement

This encompasses students' feedback on the activities and their overall performance throughout the activity. It includes their enthusiasm during the period activity was conducted.

b. Activity experience

This includes the reflections provided by the students post-activity, and their feedback on the activity conducted in the class to teach the content.

c. Communication challenges

This encompasses the difficulties faced by students while writing their responses in agree-disagree line-ups specifically or formulating their answers in Urdu to the assigned question.

d. Demonstrated Understanding

It includes the performance of each student during the activity, (specifically jigsaw activity). It shows that students eagerly adapted to the process of learning and learned the content enthusiastically.

e. Learning outcomes

It relates to the level and quality of knowledge or skills acquired. It defines the content learned by or acquired by students through the activity and imparted to their fellow classmates or delivered orally to the teacher during oral Q/A session.

f. Efficiency/pacing

It was defined as the rate at which learning or progress is occurring. It defines the speed of learning of the students and the pace at which the content was learned by the students especially during Jigsaw activity when they were divided into groups.

These refined definitions ensured each theme directly addressed the research aim, providing a clear framework for the final analysis.

4.5 Producing the Report or Manuscript:

In the final phase of Braun and Clarke's (2006) thematic analysis, the findings from the thematic analysis of post-intervention reflections were synthesized into a comprehensive report to address the research aim of evaluating the effectiveness of cooperative learning strategies in enhancing Grade VIII students' classroom performance in a Karachi government school.

The defined themes revealed significant improvements over the pre-intervention baseline, where students exhibited low interest and participation within 40 minutes of Social Studies lessons.

From the analysis, it can be concluded that;

1. If students are guided correctly about the cooperative activities, they enjoy the process more than they enjoy the traditional classroom environment.
2. Students' engagement in the class can be improved by engaging them in activities, such as cooperative learning activities.
3. Knowledge or content retaining time among students can be improved by conducting Jigsaw activities regularly or periodically.
4. Jigsaw activity, specifically, enhances students' communication skills, as when they impart learned content in a home group, their communicative skills come into action and are nurtured.
5. These findings affirm the efficacy of cooperative learning in fostering engagement and learning.

CHAPTER FIVE

CONCLUSIONS & IMPLICATIONS

5.1 Findings and Conclusion:

The research aimed to implement Cooperative learning strategies in Social Studies classrooms by incorporating them in lessons. The lessons were planned accordingly and were conducted in a public sector school. The subjects of the research were the students of Class VIIIC. The research began from January 27th, 2025 to February 6th, 2025 in 3 cycles.

The research findings and discussion in chapter IV show that students showed engagement in lessons designed by incorporating cooperative learning strategies and provided positive feedback. Throughout the cycles, the researcher implemented Agree-Disagree Line-ups, Jigsaw method, and Think-Pair share. The

key reason to incorporate different strategies was to find out which cooperative learning strategy is the most effective.

Based on the results of data analysis it is inferred and can be concluded that Cooperative learning techniques are more engaging than traditional lecture methods. Cooperative learning strategies provide students with the opportunity to take the lead of their learning. Moreover, it keeps them active throughout the lesson. Moreover, these strategies create room for communication between classmates that nurtures their communicating skills as well. Think-pair share and Agree-Disagree Line-ups provide opportunities for critical thinking. Jigsaw Method, specifically, is useful for practicing information retention and transfer of knowledge.

5.2 Implications:

Based on the results of research, the implementation of Cooperative learning strategies has proved to improve students' engagement and class experience. It also improved their critical thinking and communication skills. The researcher believes that Social Studies' lessons can be made more engaging and successful by incorporating Cooperative Learning strategies and the time of the class can be effectively utilised by engaging students in active learning and discussions. The use of cooperative learning strategies can enhance students' overall learning in a restricted time frame, creating opportunities of learning and enjoyment at the same time.

5.3 Limitations:

The study is limited to applying Cooperative Learning strategies in Social Studies classrooms at a public sector school. It specifically focuses on using Cooperative Learning Strategies for the students in Grade VIII C.

The research concentrates solely on improving students' learning and making it effective in Social Studies classroom by incorporating Agree-Disagree Line-Ups, Think-Pair Share, and Jigsaw Method as cooperative learning strategies specifically.

The findings are based on a sample of 8 female students of Class VIII C, which may not generalize to other grades, schools, or mixed-gender groups.

The use of Cooperative learning strategies, while effective in this study, may require significant time and effort for preparation and execution, which can limit its application on larger groups or bigger classrooms.

REFERENCES

- Agarwal, P. (2019). In the Stage of School Education, Social Studies are a Compulsory Subject. *We'Ken-International Journal of Basic and Applied Sciences*, 4(1), 1-5.
- Ajaja, R., & Mezieobi, S. A. (2018). Effect of Cooperative learning strategy on students performance in social studies. *International Journal of Education and Evaluation*, 4(9), 96-103
- Akpan, U. J., & Nkan, E. L. (2022). The effects of lecture method and collaborative learning on students' academic achievement in social studies in Akwa Ibom State. *International Journal of Research in Education, Science and Technology*, 5(2), 99-108.
- Ali, T., & Karim, S. (2021). Teaching and learning in social studies classrooms in Pakistan. In

Social Studies Education in South and South East Asian Contexts (pp. 131-144).
Routledge.

Aliyu, A. Y. (2017). Effects of Inquiry and Lecture Methods on Social Studies Students' Performance in Colleges of Education

Anna Abramczyk & Susanne Jurkowski (2020): Cooperative learning as an evidence-based teaching strategy: what teachers know, believe, and how they use it, *Journal of Education for Teaching*, DOI: 10.1080/02607476.2020.1733402

Anse, L., & Ilham, M. (2018, July). The Implementation of Cooperative Learning (Numbered Head Together) to Boost Students' Learning Outcome in Social Studies Subject. In *IOP Conference Series: Earth and Environmental Science* (Vol. 175, No. 1, p. 012147). IOP Publishing.

Braun, V., & Clarke, V. (2006). Using thematic analysis in psychology. *Qualitative research in psychology*, 3(2), 77-101.

Charles Igel & Vicki Urquhart (2012) Generation Z, Meet Cooperative Learning, *Middle School Journal*, 43:4, 16-21, DOI: 10.1080/00940771.2012.11461816

Çolak, E. (2015). The effect of cooperative learning on the learning approaches of students with different learning styles. *Eurasian Journal of Educational Research*, 15(59), 17-34.

Felder, R. M., & Brent, R. (2007). Cooperative learning. *Active learning: Models from the analytical sciences*, 970, 34-53. DOI: 10.1021/bk-2007-0970.ch004

Gull, F., & Shehzad, S. (2015). Effects of cooperative learning on students' academic achievement. *Journal of education and learning (EduLearn)*, 9(3), 246-255.

Herianto, A., Nurjannah, N., Mahsup, M., Muhardini, S., Ibrahim, I., & Fitriani, E. (2021). Efforts to Improve Activeness and Learning Outcomes of Integrated Social Sciences Through Time

Token Type Cooperative Learning Model. *Jurnal Kependidikan: Jurnal Hasil Penelitian Dan Kajian Kepustakaan Di Bidang Pendidikan, Pengajaran Dan Pembelajaran*, 7(3), 719-728

Hosseini, K., Navkhasi, J., & Shahsavari, H. (2017). The effect of cooperative learning on the student's academic achievement. *European Journal of Education Studies*.

Hultquist, B. L. (2024). Using Lecture in Active Classrooms. *Innovative Teaching Strategies in Nursing and Related Health Professions*, 115.

Ismail, I. (2020). The implementation of jigsaw type cooperative learning model to improve student learning outcomes of senior high school seulumun in aceh besar regency. *Budapest International Research and Critics in Linguistics and Education (BirLE) Journal*, 3(3), 1267-1273.

Joanna Sullivan (1996) Implementing a Cooperative Learning Research Model: How It Applies to a Social Studies Unit, *The Social Studies*, 87:5, 210-216, DOI: 10.1080/00377996.1996.9958441

Johnson, D. W. (1991). *Cooperative Learning: Increasing College Faculty Instructional Productivity*. ASHE-ERIC Higher Education Report No. 4, 1991. ASHE-ERIC Higher Education Reports, George Washington University, One Dupont Circle, Suite 630, Washington, DC 20036-1183.

Kasmiati, S., Surdin, S., & Lestari, V. E. (2023). Increasing Students' Learning Outcomes Through the Script Model of Cooperative Learning in Secondary School. *AL-ISHLAH: Jurnal Pendidikan*, 15(2), 1924-1931.

Kelley, C. (2021). "Social Studies is Boring": The Role of Student Attitude and Achievement in the

Middle School Social Studies Classroom (Doctoral dissertation, Ohio Dominican University).

Khakim, M. A., Roesminingsih, M. V., Murigi, P. N., Suprijono, A., & Subroto, W. T. (2019). The Implementation of Cooperative Learning Make a Match to improve Social science learning activities and learning outcomes. *International Journal of Scientific and Research Publications (IJSRP)*, 9(3), 321-328.

Lynda Baloch (1994) Breaking Down the Walls, *The Social Studies*, 85:1, 25-30,
DOI:10.1080/00377996.1994.10118776

Nelson, J. L. (2001). Defining social studies. *Critical issues in social studies research for the 21st century*, 1, 15-38.

Salamah, P. U. (2019). Improving Motivation and Learning Achievement of Social Sciences Through Combined Jigsaw Method With Silent Reading Technique At Secondary School. *revista aus*.

Schug, M. C. (1982). Why kids don't like social studies.

Shah, S. I. H., Nazir, F., & Fazal, S. (2024). Developing Social Self-Efficacy and Self-Esteem Through Cooperative Learning in Social Studies Classrooms. *Academy of Education and Social Sciences Review*, 4(2), 137-148.

Slavin, R. E. (1983). *Cooperative learning*. New York.

Toklucu, S. K., & Tay, B. (2016). The effect of cooperative learning method and systematic teaching on students' achievement and retention of knowledge in social studies lesson. *Eurasian Journal of Educational Research*, 16(66), 315-334.

Yang, X. (2023). A historical review of collaborative learning and cooperative learning. *TechTrends*, 67(4), 718-728.

